

Brief Better, *Build Faster.*

The one-page framework that separates people
who get results from AI from people who don't.

Inside:

- The three-question brief framework
- Two fully worked examples
- The honesty instruction that changes every AI conversation

Brief Better, Build Faster

Most people are one habit away from getting dramatically better results from AI. Not a new tool. Not a course. A habit: defining what done looks like before you start the conversation.

Right now, the majority of people using AI type a vague request, get a vague response, decide the tool isn't that useful, and move on. The problem was never the tool. It was the brief.

A brief is simply the set of instructions, context, and constraints you give AI before it does anything. The quality of your brief is almost entirely responsible for the quality of what comes back. This framework takes ten minutes to learn and changes every AI interaction you have from this point forward.

The Three-Question Brief

Before any conversation that matters, answer these three questions. Write them down before you open the tool.

01 What is the goal?

Not a category - a specific output. Not "I want help with my resume" but "I need a one-page resume for a mid-level marketing role at a tech company, emphasising three years of campaign management experience and one major result - a campaign that generated 40% more leads than the previous year." Specific goals produce specific outputs. Categories produce templates.

02 What are the constraints?

Tone, audience, length, things already tried, things that are off the table. Constraints aren't limitations - they're the parameters that make the output useful rather than generic. "No corporate language. Under 300 words. Written for someone who has never heard of this product before." Negative space shapes output as much as the brief itself.

03 What does good look like?

If you got the perfect output, what would it let you do? What decision would it help you make? What action would it unlock? Working backwards from this question almost always reveals something missing from the brief you were about to send.

The framework in practice

Here's the same request, with and without the three-question brief.

WITHOUT THE BRIEF

"Help me prepare for a job interview."

What comes back: a generic list of tips that applies to every interview in every industry everywhere. Technically correct. Practically useless.

WITH THE THREE-QUESTION BRIEF

Goal: "I have a second-round interview in three days for a product manager role at a fintech startup. I need to prepare for likely questions, sharpen my answer to 'why do you want to move from engineering to product,' and develop two or three strong questions to ask at the end."

Constraints: "I have four years of engineering experience and no formal product title yet. The company is Series B, around 60 people, focused on small business lending. I don't want generic interview advice - I want preparation specific to this transition and this company stage."

What good looks like: "A focused prep document I can review the night before - likely questions with a suggested structure for each answer, and three sharp closing questions that show I understand the product space."

The output from the second brief is a preparation document you'd actually use. Same tool. Same model. Completely different result.

ONE MORE EXAMPLE - FOR SOMEONE BUILDING SOMETHING

Goal: "I want to identify two or three realistic business ideas I could start in the next 90 days without quitting my job, based on skills I already have."

Constraints: "I'm a primary school teacher with five years experience. I have roughly ten hours a week available outside work. I don't want ideas that require technical skills or upfront inventory. Budget to start is under \$500 AUD."

What good looks like: "Two or three ideas with a one-paragraph rationale for each - why it fits my background, what the first paying customer looks like, and what I'd need to do in the first two weeks to test it."

The one instruction worth adding to every brief

Once you've written your brief using the three questions, add this line at the end before you send it:

HONESTY INSTRUCTION - ADD TO ANY CONVERSATION THAT MATTERS

"If my brief is missing something important, flag it before you answer. If my premise is off, tell me. A direct correction is more useful to me than a polished answer to the wrong question."

That instruction changes the quality of every conversation you have from this point forward. It turns the tool from an answer machine into a thinking partner.

What this unlocks

The brief is the foundation. Once you have it, everything else - building a website, shipping a product, planning a launch, making a decision - is a matter of applying the same three questions to a new context.

Most people spend months getting inconsistent results from AI and assuming the tool is the problem. You now know it isn't.

READY TO BUILD SOMETHING REAL?

This framework is the starting point. The Aktico Foundation Playbook takes you from here to shipping something live on the internet - a website or interactive game, built in an afternoon, using the exact process this framework sets up.

Get the full playbook at aktico.co - \$7 USD.

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